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Lead Software Developer (Ref: 18319)

Ministry of Justice

Apply before 11:55 pm on Thursday 18th June 2026

Ministry of
JUSTICE

Reference number

464817

Salary

£58,511 - £70,725

The national salary range is £58,511 - £65,329 London salary range is £63,343 - £70,725. Your salary will be dependent on your base location
London: £63,343 - £78,225 (which may include an allowance of up to £14,882)

National: £58,511 - £73,450 (which may include an allowance of up to £14,939)

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Grade 7

Grade 7

Contract type

Permanent

Type of role

Digital

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Part-time

Number of jobs available

1

Contents

Location

About the job

Benefits

Things you need to know

Apply and further information

Location

East Midlands (England), East of England, London (region), North East England, North West England, Scotland, South East England, South West England, Wales, West Midlands (England), Yorkshire and the Humber

About the job

Job summary

This position is based Nationally

Job description

Lead Software Developer

Location: National*

Closing Date: 18 June

Interviews: w/c 6 July

Grade: 7

(MoJ candidates who are on a specialist grade, will be able to retain this grade on lateral transfer)

Salary:**

London: £63,343 - £78,225 (which may include an allowance of up to £14,882)

National: £58,511 - £73,450 (which may include an allowance of up to £14,939)

Working pattern: full-time, part-time, flexible working

Contract Type: Permanent

Number of vacancies: 1

(Please note additional roles may become available, subject to approval)

Vacancy number: 18319

***We offer a hybrid working model, allowing for a balance between remote work and time spent in your local office. Office locations can be found [ON THIS MAP](#)**

Please note that unless you are an existing member of staff at Justice Digital, Data and Science, the only London location being recruited to is 10 South Colonnade, E14 4PU. We are no longer recruiting to 102 Petty France, SW1H 9AJ.

The Role

Please note this role requires you to pass [Security Check](#) clearance. Please click on the [link](#) for details.

We are recruiting for a **Lead Developer** here at [Justice Digital](#), to be part of our warm and collaborative Developer Experience team which sits in the Office of the Chief Technology Officer (OCTO).

This role aligns against the [Lead Developer Role](#) from the Government Digital and Data Framework

OCTO sets technical direction across the organisation. It defines standards, shapes platforms and ways of working, and supports teams to build and operate services that are secure, reliable and sustainable.

This role focuses on improving how engineers work by defining standards and ensuring they are implemented through shared tooling rather than guidance alone. You will play an integral part in central teams responsible for Developer Experience (DevX) and the Developer Portal, working closely with platform, security and architecture teams.

You will be confident working with other developers on our tech stack and comfortable learning new technologies and systems. We use a variety of different technologies and will work with you to place you in a team that matches your skills, interests and aspirations wherever possible.

You will work with user researchers, product managers, designers, delivery managers, technical architects and content specialists who share a vision for improving government through smarter use of technology.

You'll receive a range of excellent benefits when you join our department, including:

A generous employer pension contribution of 28.97% through the Civil Service Pension Scheme.

25 days of annual leave, (increasing to 30 days once you have reached 5 years of service), plus 8 bank holidays and a privilege day for the King's birthday.

Flexible working arrangements including hybrid working, working part time or compressed hours. Designed to support a positive work-life balance.

Employees are allocated **10% of their working time for personal and professional development.**

A £1k per person learning budget is in place to support all our people, with access to best-in-class conferences and seminars, accreditation with professional bodies, fully funded vocational programmes and e-learning platforms.

Compassionate maternity, adoption, and shared parental leave policies, with up to 26 weeks leave at full pay, 13 weeks with partial pay, and 13 weeks further leave. And maternity support/paternity leave at full pay for 2 weeks, too!

You can find more details of the Benefits we offer [here](#). To help picture your life at MoJ Justice Digital, Data and Science please take a look at our [blog](#).

Our Tech Stack

We use a range of technologies and we're looking for people who specialise in **one or more** of them (**Python or Java**) and who love learning new languages and frameworks.

For example, we might use **Python** to write our application code, **Circle CI** or **GitHub Actions** for CI/CD, **Sentry** for application monitoring, **Kubernetes** and **Docker** to schedule and run our services (read about our Cloud Platform), **AWS** for most of our infrastructure, **GOV.UK Design System** for our web interfaces and use **Macbook Pros**.

For front-end development, we value a robust understanding of the underlying web technologies. We value well-maintained, open-source tools

that can be used to produce semantic **HTML**, performant **CSS** and unobtrusive **JavaScript** or **TypeScript**, and we assess all our services against **accessibility** criteria.

We're happy to help you learn our tech stack once you're part of our team, and do not require an exact match in your experience of languages. Check out [GitHub](#) for a closer look at the technologies we use, and a complete list of services that we build and maintain. We subscribe to the [manifesto for agile software development](#).

Our Community

We currently have over 200+ experienced developers who make up the engineering community across the MoJ. You will coach and mentor junior colleagues and take part in informal support networks with your peers. You will be encouraged to play an active role in the engineering community and culture.

We take the responsibility of supportive and effective line management very seriously. We will value the skills you bring to the civil service and help you to build on them. When the time is right, we will support moving between teams or government departments to learn different technologies, or take on more responsibility, according to your career goals.

Take a look at our [developer blog](#) to get a sense of our work and culture.

Key Responsibilities

This role combines a number of key disciplines in addition to hands-on development and writing code. You will inspire, mentor, coach, manage and lead software developers within a business domain. You will also focus on generating a culture of quality, maintaining balance between building sustainable well architected products and unlocking citizen value early

The areas of your responsibility for leadership will shift between people, architecture, development and product strategy, depending on context and need

You will contribute to the technical leadership in DevX team, specifically Developer Tooling. There will be opportunity to line manage several Senior Developers as the team expands into Developer Portal.

Technical Leadership

Taking responsibility for tickets and releasing production ready code

Collaborate with Technical Architects and Product Managers to set product direction

Collaborate with Technical Architects to help in the design of systems and implementation of coherent and sustainable technical roadmaps

Lead discussions with Developers to nurture consensus on technical/team decisions

Support backlog refinement, helping plan, define and prioritise actionable tasks for the team

Build inclusivity and understanding by promoting strategies to share technical knowledge of our systems with appropriate documentation and other activities

Support Delivery Managers in unblocking value where necessary and/or honest representations of effort in an agile environment as the teams learn more

Engineering Management

Managing, coaching and growing people with a focus on their wellbeing and development

Support Delivery Managers in improving team maturity

Engineering Profession

Work with your local Principal Developer and the wider community to improve and maintain good coding standards and practices

Help provide feedback on wider technical strategy of your business unit

Share knowledge and build enthusiasm for sharing via activities like brown bags, cooperative workshops, chat discussions and other means

Encourage open discussion and drive communities in our primary communication tools

Have a mindset for growth and learning looking for emerging technologies, tools and good practice

Help build and maintain a diverse, inclusive culture across the development community, growing awareness, inclusivity, and balance

Take part in the recruitment and onboarding of other Developers

If this feels like an exciting challenge, something you are enthusiastic about, and want to join our team please read on and apply!

Person Specification

Essential

You can demonstrate proven experience of Python or Java.

You have experience of software development and writing production ready code.

You have experience nurturing a culture of good software practice that makes change easy.

You can share evidence of growing your skills in technical leadership, and advocating for your team.

You have coached other people.

You have contributed towards building a high performing, inclusive team culture.

You have experience in delivering better value sooner and safer, through DevOps, XP or other ways of working that lead to agility and collaboration.

You enjoy building long-lasting relationships and trust with others.

You have proven technical leadership skills.

You have grown sustainable teams.

Willingness to be assessed against the requirements for SC clearance.

We welcome the unique contribution diverse applicants bring and do not discriminate based on culture, ethnicity, race, nationality or national origin, age, sex, gender identity or expression, religion or belief, disability status, sexual orientation, educational or social background or any other factor.

Our values are Purpose, Humanity Openness and Together. Find out more [here](#) about how we celebrate diversity and an inclusive culture in our workplace.

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan](#) and the [Civil Service D&I Strategy](#).

Salary Information**

Base salary for this role is from £58,511 to £65,329 (National) or from £63,343 to £70,725 (London).

New entrants to the Civil Service joining the MoJ are expected to start at the minimum of the pay band.

Existing Civil Servants moving on a level transfer will retain their current base salary or move to the minimum of the pay band for the role, whichever is higher.

Existing Civil Servants who are promoted will either move to the bottom of the new grade's pay band or receive a 10% uplift, whichever provides the greater increase.

Candidates may also be eligible for a non-pensionable Government Digital & Data Allowance of up to £14,882 per year (London) or £14,939 (National). This is a temporary allowance, reviewed annually and may be retained, amended, or withdrawn.

The final offer will reflect the skills and experience you demonstrate during the assessment process.

Why JDDS?

Over the past year, we have strengthened our focus on attracting and retaining women and non-binary people in technical roles across the Ministry of Justice. We have steadily been increasing representation through targeted activity, including community forums, support and mentoring, and visible senior allyship committed to sustained improvement.

We're proud to back this up with action. Our internal **Women in Digital, Data and Science Forum** builds community for women and non-binary colleagues

across all grades, creating space to share experiences, grow confidence, and shape practical changes. We also support cross-government work to remove barriers for women and girls entering and progressing in tech, and we offer routes in through **apprenticeships** and structured development.

We're proud that this work is recognised externally too: Justice Digital, Data and Science (Ministry of Justice) was named **Best Employer of the Year** at the Women in Tech Excellence Awards 2025.

Read more about our work and culture in the blog posts below:

Six Months in Building the Women in Engineering Working Group, by Rosie Bringham, Deputy Head of Profession for Engineering.

Designing Digital Services for Everyone: Why LGBTQ+ History Still Matters, by Mark Stanley, Deputy Director for Prisons.

It started with a Quiz: Discovering a Different Kind of Strength, by Eva Horvathova, Capability Manager.

Our values are Purpose, Humanity, Openness and Together. Find out more here about how we celebrate diversity and foster an inclusive culture in our workplace.

Use of Artificial Intelligence

Artificial Intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our candidate guidance for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Terms & Conditions

Please review our Terms and Conditions which set out how we recruit and provide further information related to the role and salary arrangements.

If you have any questions, please feel free to contact digitalanddatarecruitment@justice.gov.uk

Person specification

Please refer to attached Job Description

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £58,511, Ministry of Justice contributes £16,950 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides.](#)

Access to learning and development

A working environment that supports a range of flexible working options to enhance your work life balance

A working culture which encourages inclusion and diversity

A Civil Service pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Annual Leave

Public Holidays

Season Ticket Advance

For more information about the recruitment process, benefits and allowances and answers to general queries, please click the below link which will direct you to our Candidate Information Page.

Link: <https://justicejobs.tal.net/vx/candidate/cms/About%20the%20MOJ>

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our

[candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

How to Apply

In Justice Digital, Data and Science, we recruit using a combination of the **Government Digital and Data Profession Capability** and **Success Profiles** Frameworks. We shall assess a combination of your Experience, Technical skills and Behaviours during the assessment process.

Stage 1 - Application and sift:

To apply for this position, you must submit the following as part of your application:

A **CV** detailing your career history (including any relevant qualifications). Your CV will be assessed against the essential criteria outlined within the Person Specification of this advert.

A **Personal Statement** (no more than **750 words**) which should outline your experience and skills, giving clear examples of work undertaken. It should specifically address the following 2 criteria listed below, using a separate paragraph for each.

You can demonstrate proven experience of Python or Java.

You can share evidence of growing your skills in technical leadership, and advocating for your team.

A diverse sift panel will review the information in your CV and Personal Statement to assess the sift criteria specified above. We operate an anonymous shortlisting process. **Please ensure your CV and Personal Statement do not include your name or any other identifying details.**

Should we receive a high volume of applications, a pre-sift based on You can demonstrate proven experience of Python or Java will be conducted before the sift.

Please access the following link for guidance on how to apply - [Application Guidance](#)

Stage 2 - Interviews:

Successful candidates who meet the required standard will then be invited to a panel interview held via Microsoft Teams. At interview stage, you will be assessed against the following Success Profile elements - Experience, Technical and the following Behaviours:

- Leadership

- Developing self and others

- Communicating and influencing

As part of your interview, you will be asked to deliver a live Code Review that assesses your technical capability. Further details will be provided if successful at sift.

Appointments are made strictly in merit order. In the event that two or more candidates receive identical interview scores, the **Leadership** will be applied as the primary lead criterion to determine the final merit order.

Should you be unsuccessful in the role that you have applied for but demonstrate the capability for a role at a lower level, we reserve the right to discuss this opportunity with you and offer you the position without needing a further application.

A reserve list may be held for up to 12 months, from which further appointments may be made.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name :	SSCL Recruitment Enquiries Team
Email :	moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@resourcing.soprasteria.co.uk
Telephone :	0345 241 5359
Recruitment team	
Email :	moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@resourcing.soprasteria.co.uk

Further information

Appointment to the Civil Service is governed by the Civil Service Commission's Recruitment Principles. If you feel a department has breached the requirement of the Recruitment Principles and would like to raise this, please contact SSCL (Moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@gov.sscl.com) in the first instance. If the role has been advertised externally (outside of the Civil Service) and you are not satisfied with the response, you may bring your complaint to the Commission. For further information on bringing a complaint to the Civil Service Commission please visit their web pages: <http://civilservicecommission.independent.gov.uk/civil-service-recruitment/complaints/>

[https://www.jobtrain.co.uk/justicedigital/Job/JobDetail?
jobid=1075&isPreview=Yes&advert=external References](https://www.jobtrain.co.uk/justicedigital/Job/JobDetail?jobid=1075&isPreview=Yes&advert=external References)

Follow link to apply

[https://www.jobtrain.co.uk/justicedigital/Job/JobDetail?
jobid=1075&isPreview=Yes&advert=external References](https://www.jobtrain.co.uk/justicedigital/Job/JobDetail?jobid=1075&isPreview=Yes&advert=external References)

